Lesson 2 Reading Homework

Era 2: Contact & Colonization (1491–1607) · Focus: Exploration · Columbian Exchange · Spanish empire

Reading due today: AMSCO 1.3, 1.4, 1.5, 1.6, 1.7

> *Connect: European contact did not touch an 'empty' continent — it collided with the societies you just read about in Lesson 1. Track who gained and who lost in the Columbian Exchange.*

Learning Objective(s) for today

– **1.3 (LO C):** Explain the causes of exploration and conquest of the New World by various European nations.

– **1.4 (LO D):** Explain the causes of the Columbian Exchange and its effect on Europe and the Americas over time.

– **1.5 (LO E):** Explain how the growth of the Spanish Empire shaped the development of social and economic structures over time.

As you read, identify each of the following:

Terms (define in 1–2 sentences)

[ ] Columbian Exchange
[ ] encomienda system
[ ] casta system
[ ] mission system
[ ] Black Legend
[ ] Requerimiento
[ ] joint-stock company

People (name + role/significance in 1 sentence)

[ ] Christopher Columbus
[ ] Hernán Cortés
[ ] Bartolomé de las Casas
[ ] Prince Henry the Navigator
[ ] Moctezuma

Events (year + one-sentence significance)

[ ] Columbus's first voyage (1492)
[ ] Treaty of Tordesillas (1494)
[ ] conquest of the Aztecs (1519–21)
[ ] founding of St. Augustine (1565)

Reading Focus Questions

Answer in 2–4 complete sentences each. Use specific evidence from the reading.

1. Define the Columbian Exchange and give ONE example each of something that moved from the Americas to Europe/Africa and from Europe/Africa to the Americas.

2. How did the encomienda and casta systems shape social and economic structures in Spain's American empire?

3. How did Spaniards such as Bartolome de las Casas debate the treatment of Indigenous peoples, and what reforms resulted?